COLD WAR END AND NEW WORLD ORDER

SOVIET COLLAPSE MECHANISM → AGENCY ABOVE AND BELOW → COLLAPSE CHRONOLOGY → YUGOSLAV BREAKDOWN → BOSNIA TO KOSOVO → EUROPEAN INTEGRATION LADDER

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 SOVIET COLLAPSE MECHANISM

SOVIET COLLAPSE MECHANISM | PERFORMANCE LEGITIMACY FALLS | CRITICISM AND REFORM EXPAND | ALTERNATIVES ORGANISE | NON-USE OF FORCE | CONTROL BECOMES IRREVERSIBLE COLLAPSE

STAGNATION → performance legitimacy falls → GLASNOST/PERESTROIKA → criticism and reform expand → NATIONALISM/YELTSIN → alternatives organise → NON-USE OF FORCE → control becomes irreversible collapse

CORE CLAIM
- STAGNATION → performance legitimacy falls
- GLASNOST/PERESTROIKA → criticism and reform expand

MECHANISM
- NATIONALISM/YELTSIN → alternatives organise
- NON-USE OF FORCE → control becomes irreversible collapse

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- STAGNATION → performance legitimacy falls
- GLASNOST/PERESTROIKA → criticism and reform expand

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NON-USE OF FORCE → control becomes irreversible collapse.

01

STAGE 01 AGENCY ABOVE AND BELOW

AGENCY ABOVE AND BELOW | REFORM AND RESTRAINT FROM ABOVE | RIVAL ELITE CENTRE | ORGANISED STRIKES FROM BELOW | STRUCTURE, CHOICE AND MOBILISATION CONVERGE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
GORBACHEV → reform and restraint from above	SOLIDARITY → organised strikes from below	GORBACHEV → reform and restraint from above
YELTSIN → rival elite centre	RESULT → structure, choice and mobilisation converge	YELTSIN → rival elite centre

CORE CLAIM
- GORBACHEV → reform and restraint from above
- YELTSIN → rival elite centre

MECHANISM
- SOLIDARITY → organised strikes from below
- RESULT → structure, choice and mobilisation converge

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- GORBACHEV → reform and restraint from above
- YELTSIN → rival elite centre

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOLIDARITY → organised strikes from below; RESULT → structure, choice and mobilisation converge.

02

STAGE 02 COLLAPSE CHRONOLOGY

COLLAPSE CHRONOLOGY | GORBACHEV TAKES POWER | AUG 1988 | SOLIDARITY STRIKES IN POLAND | EASTERN EUROPEAN REGIMES COLLAPSE | USSR DISSOLVES; GORBACHEV RESIGNS

1985 → Gorbachev takes power → AUG 1988 → Solidarity strikes in Poland → 1989 → eastern European regimes collapse → 1991 → USSR dissolves; Gorbachev resigns

CORE CLAIM
- 1985 → Gorbachev takes power
- AUG 1988 → Solidarity strikes in Poland

MECHANISM
- 1989 → eastern European regimes collapse
- 1991 → USSR dissolves; Gorbachev resigns

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1985 → Gorbachev takes power
- AUG 1988 → Solidarity strikes in Poland

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1989 → eastern European regimes collapse; 1991 → USSR dissolves; Gorbachev resigns.

03

STAGE 03 YUGOSLAV BREAKDOWN

YUGOSLAV BREAKDOWN | FEDERAL ORDER | LOSES COMMUNIST BINDING FRAMEWORK | MOBILISE AGGRESSIVE NATIONALISM | MIXED POPULATIONS | TERRITORIAL CLAIMS OVERLAP | WAR AND DISPLACEMENT DEEPEN

FEDERAL ORDER → loses communist binding framework → LEADERS → mobilise aggressive nationalism → MIXED POPULATIONS → territorial claims overlap → HESITATION → war and displacement deepen

CORE CLAIM
- FEDERAL ORDER → loses communist binding framework
- LEADERS → mobilise aggressive nationalism

MECHANISM
- MIXED POPULATIONS → territorial claims overlap
- HESITATION → war and displacement deepen

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- FEDERAL ORDER → loses communist binding framework
- LEADERS → mobilise aggressive nationalism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MIXED POPULATIONS → territorial claims overlap; HESITATION → war and displacement deepen.

04

STAGE 04 BOSNIA TO KOSOVO

BOSNIA TO KOSOVO | YUGOSLAV WARS AND ETHNIC CLEANSING | DAYTON SETTLES BOSNIA | DISPUTES REMAIN | KOSOVO CRISIS AND NATO INTERVENTION

1991-95 → Yugoslav wars and ethnic cleansing → 1995 → Dayton settles Bosnia → BOUNDARIES → disputes remain → 1999 → Kosovo crisis and NATO intervention

CORE CLAIM
- 1991-95 → Yugoslav wars and ethnic cleansing
- 1995 → Dayton settles Bosnia

MECHANISM
- BOUNDARIES → disputes remain
- 1999 → Kosovo crisis and NATO intervention

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1991-95 → Yugoslav wars and ethnic cleansing
- 1995 → Dayton settles Bosnia

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARIES → disputes remain; 1999 → Kosovo crisis and NATO intervention.

05

STAGE 05 EUROPEAN INTEGRATION LADDER

EUROPEAN INTEGRATION LADDER | ECSC POOLS STRATEGIC INDUSTRY | TREATY OF ROME CREATES EEC | FIRST ENLARGEMENT | MAASTRICHT CREATES DEEPER EU FRAMEWORK

1951-52 → ECSC pools strategic industry → 1957 → Treaty of Rome creates EEC → 1973 → first enlargement → 1992-93 → Maastricht creates deeper EU framework

CORE CLAIM
- 1951-52 → ECSC pools strategic industry
- 1957 → Treaty of Rome creates EEC

MECHANISM
- 1973 → first enlargement
- 1992-93 → Maastricht creates deeper EU framework

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1951-52 → ECSC pools strategic industry
- 1957 → Treaty of Rome creates EEC

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1973 → first enlargement; 1992-93 → Maastricht creates deeper EU framework.

06

STAGE 06 DEEPENING VERSUS WIDENING

DEEPENING VERSUS WIDENING | POLITICAL AND MONETARY AUTHORITY EXPANDS | MORE STATES ENTER | FORMER COMMUNIST STATES JOIN | SOVEREIGNTY AND UNEQUAL ECONOMIES PERSIST

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DEEPENING → political and monetary authority expands	2004 → former communist states join	DEEPENING → political and monetary authority expands
WIDENING → more states enter	TENSION → sovereignty and unequal economies persist	WIDENING → more states enter

CORE CLAIM
- DEEPENING → political and monetary authority expands
- WIDENING → more states enter

MECHANISM
- 2004 → former communist states join
- TENSION → sovereignty and unequal economies persist

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DEEPENING → political and monetary authority expands
- WIDENING → more states enter

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2004 → former communist states join; TENSION → sovereignty and unequal economies persist.

07

STAGE 07 NEW-ORDER CLAIM

NEW-ORDER CLAIM | USA APPEARS SOLE SUPERPOWER | CONSENT REMAINS INCOMPLETE | UN AUTHORITY STILL MATTERS | UNIPOLAR MOMENT, CONTESTED ORDER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CAPABILITY → USA appears sole superpower	INSTITUTIONS → UN authority still matters	CAPABILITY → USA appears sole superpower
LEGITIMACY → consent remains incomplete	VERDICT → unipolar moment, contested order	LEGITIMACY → consent remains incomplete

CORE CLAIM
- CAPABILITY → USA appears sole superpower
- LEGITIMACY → consent remains incomplete

MECHANISM
- INSTITUTIONS → UN authority still matters
- VERDICT → unipolar moment, contested order

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CAPABILITY → USA appears sole superpower
- LEGITIMACY → consent remains incomplete

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INSTITUTIONS → UN authority still matters; VERDICT → unipolar moment, contested order.

08

STAGE 08 WAR-ON-TERROR SEQUENCE

WAR-ON-TERROR SEQUENCE | 11 SEPT 2001 | TRANSNATIONAL ATTACK | TALIBAN REGIME TARGETED | DISPERSED NETWORKS BECOME CENTRAL | IRAQ 2003 | INTERVENTION DIVIDES THE ORDER

11 SEPT 2001 → transnational attack → AFGHANISTAN → Taliban regime targeted → SECURITY → dispersed networks become central → IRAQ 2003 → intervention divides the order

CORE CLAIM
- 11 SEPT 2001 → transnational attack
- AFGHANISTAN → Taliban regime targeted

MECHANISM
- SECURITY → dispersed networks become central
- IRAQ 2003 → intervention divides the order

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 11 SEPT 2001 → transnational attack
- AFGHANISTAN → Taliban regime targeted

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SECURITY → dispersed networks become central; IRAQ 2003 → intervention divides the order.

09

STAGE 09 IRAQ LEGITIMACY TEST

IRAQ LEGITIMACY TEST | US-UK CAPACITY TO INVADE | NO CLEAR SECURITY COUNCIL BASIS | INSTITUTIONAL DISAGREEMENT | CAPABILITY CANNOT MANUFACTURE LEGITIMACY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
POWER → US-UK capacity to invade	RESULT → institutional disagreement	POWER → US-UK capacity to invade
AUTHORISATION → no clear Security Council basis	LESSON → capability cannot manufacture legitimacy	AUTHORISATION → no clear Security Council basis

CORE CLAIM
- POWER → US-UK capacity to invade
- AUTHORISATION → no clear Security Council basis

MECHANISM
- RESULT → institutional disagreement
- LESSON → capability cannot manufacture legitimacy

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- POWER → US-UK capacity to invade
- AUTHORISATION → no clear Security Council basis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → institutional disagreement; LESSON → capability cannot manufacture legitimacy.

10

STAGE 10 ARAB SPRING DIVERGENCE

ARAB SPRING DIVERGENCE | DEC 2010 | PROTESTS BEGIN IN TUNISIA | COMMON GRIEVANCE | UPRISINGS SPREAD | RESPONSE CAPACITY DIFFERS | EXTERNAL ROLE | OUTCOMES DIVERGE SHARPLY

DEC 2010 → protests begin in Tunisia → COMMON GRIEVANCE → uprisings spread → STATE/ARMY → response capacity differs → EXTERNAL ROLE → outcomes diverge sharply

CORE CLAIM
- DEC 2010 → protests begin in Tunisia
- COMMON GRIEVANCE → uprisings spread

MECHANISM
- STATE/ARMY → response capacity differs
- EXTERNAL ROLE → outcomes diverge sharply

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DEC 2010 → protests begin in Tunisia
- COMMON GRIEVANCE → uprisings spread

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATE/ARMY → response capacity differs; EXTERNAL ROLE → outcomes diverge sharply.

11

STAGE 11 NEW WORLD ORDER ANSWER SPINE

NEW WORLD ORDER ANSWER SPINE | STAGNATION, REFORM, MOBILISATION AND RESTRAINT | YUGOSLAV FRAGMENTATION PLUS EU ENLARGEMENT | US PREDOMINANCE TESTED BY TERROR AND IRAQ | NO LINEAR DEMOCRATIC OR UNIPOLAR SETTLEMENT

COLLAPSE → stagnation, reform, mobilisation and restraint → EUROPE → Yugoslav fragmentation plus EU enlargement → ORDER → US predominance tested by terror and Iraq → VERDICT → no linear democratic or unipolar settlement

CORE CLAIM
- COLLAPSE → stagnation, reform, mobilisation and restraint
- EUROPE → Yugoslav fragmentation plus EU enlargement

MECHANISM
- ORDER → US predominance tested by terror and Iraq
- VERDICT → no linear democratic or unipolar settlement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- COLLAPSE → stagnation, reform, mobilisation and restraint
- EUROPE → Yugoslav fragmentation plus EU enlargement

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → no linear democratic or unipolar settlement.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | LOWE'S POST-1991 RUSSIA SECTIONS ARE ESPECIALLY USEFUL FOR MAINS | OF COMMUNISM DID NOT AUTOMATICALLY CREATE A HEALTHY DEMOCRACY | LOWE DOES NOT TREAT YUGOSLAVIA AS AN INEVITABLE EXPLOSION | MILOSEVIC'S SERBIAN NATIONALISM, TUDJMAN'S CROATIAN NATIONALISM, BOSNIA'S MIXED DEMOGRAPHY | INTERNATIONAL RESPONSE WAS LATE, HESITANT AND INCONSISTENT BEFORE NATO | BOSNIA AND KOSOVO ARE BEST REMEMBERED AS TESTS OF | LOWE NARRATES 9/11, AFGHANISTAN AND IRAQ IN DETAIL.

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: Lowe's post-1991 Russia sections are especially useful for Mains because they show that the collapse
- of communism did not automatically create a healthy democracy or a fair market economy .
- Lowe does not treat Yugoslavia as an inevitable explosion of "ancient" hatred.
- Milosevic's Serbian nationalism, Tudjman's Croatian nationalism, Bosnia's mixed demography and the weakness of compromise made violence more likely.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- International response was late, hesitant and inconsistent before NATO acted more decisively.
- Bosnia and Kosovo are best remembered as tests of post-Cold-War Europe and the UN, not just Balkan history.
- Lowe narrates 9/11, Afghanistan and Iraq in detail.
- CAUTION: He also includes a strong critical discussion of American foreign policy and whether state violence can itself be called terrorism.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- CAUTION: For UPSC, treat that section as historiographical debate , not as an unqualified fact to parrot.
- CAUTION: The safer exam line is: the Iraq War damaged the legitimacy of the post-Cold-War order because the justifications became heavily disputed.
- CAUTION: The Arab Spring is Lowe's reminder that authoritarian collapse does not by itself settle the problem of legitimate order.
- 25 June 2025, NATO Hague Summit Declaration: allies committed by 2035 to invest 5% of GDP annually

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels